

2026 ASA South Florida High School Data Challenge

Organized by the American Statistical Association (ASA) South Florida Chapter

Submission Deadline: February 20, 2026 (11:59pm EST)

The ASA South Florida Chapter invites **high school educators** to encourage their students to participate in the **2026 ASA South Florida High School Data Challenge**, an applied data analysis and visualization competition using real data.

Competition website and materials: <https://luminwin.github.io/ASASF/>

Student Eligibility

- Open to **any high school student worldwide**; Students compete only against other high school teams
 - Students may participate **individually or in teams of up to 4**; Each team may submit **one entry**
-

Dataset

Students will work with a curated dataset derived from the **2024 National Health and Nutrition Examination Survey (NHANES)**, containing:

- **1,200 individuals** and **97 variables**
 - Health, nutrition, demographic, and behavioral measures
 - A noise-perturbed HDL cholesterol outcome to protect privacy while preserving realistic structure
-

Two Participation Options (Students Choose One)

1. Prediction Track

Students attempt to predict HDL cholesterol values using the provided data.

- Submission:
 - `pred.csv` (predicted values)
 - Short report (≤ 4 pages) describing approach and reasoning

2. Visualization Track

Students create visualizations to explore patterns and insights in the data. No modeling or programming required

- Submission:
 - 1–4 page PDF: At least two clear charts or graphs with brief explanations
-

Awards & Recognition

- **One winning high school team** will receive **\$300** and be invited to present their work as a poster at the **2026 American Statistical Association (ASA) Florida Chapter Meeting**
 - **Top 20% of teams** will receive **certificates of recognition**
 - Participation provides students with exposure to a professional statistics organization and an authentic data-science experience
-

Submission

All submissions are collected through an [online form](#) (*File uploads require Google login due to Google Forms requirements.*)

Educator Notes

- This competition aligns well with courses in **statistics, data science, AP Statistics, computer science, and STEM enrichment**
 - Teachers are welcome to support students through guidance and instruction, but submissions must represent **students' own work**
 - The challenge may be incorporated as a class project, extracurricular activity, or independent study
-

Contact

Dr. Min Lu, American Statistical Association – South Florida Chapter, m.lu6@umiami.edu | asasfchapter@gmail.com